

LESSON 10: THE OPENER DESCRIBES

1. TWO STRENGTH RANGES

DIRECT
12–15
POINTS



REVERSE
16–20
POINTS

2. SAFETY LEVEL (SL)



The last
“**SAFE**”
contract.

3. BALANCED DIRECT

Stay below

1NT



4. UNBALANCED DIRECT

Stay below

“**2 OF THEIR SUIT**”



5. REVERSE: ALWAYS EXCEEDS THE SAFETY LEVEL



Jump shift

(e.g., 1♣–1♦
→ 2♠ = reverse!)

SOUTH	NORTH
1♣	1♦
2♠	= REVERSE!



Support
at level 3

SOUTH	NORTH
1♥	1♠
3♥	= REVERSE!



Balanced
18–20:
jump to 2NT

SOUTH	NORTH
1♣	1♦
2NT	= REVERSE!

6. AFTER A 2 OVER 1 RESPONSE

SOUTH	NORTH
1♥	2♠



DESCRIBES ONLY DISTRIBUTION
(GAME ALREADY GUARANTEED)

7. RESPONSES AND OPENER'S REBIDS

SOUTH OPENS 1♥

RESPONDER (NORTH)

1♠

2♣

2♦

2♥

2♠

2NT

3♣ / 3♦ / 3♥ / 3♠

OPENER (SOUTH) REBIDS

Raise with 4+ card support: 2♥
No support: 2♦ (showing a long diamond suit)

Raise with 4+ card support: 2♥
No support: 2♦ (showing a long diamond suit)

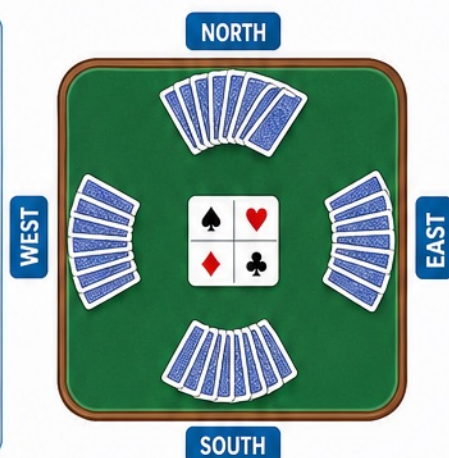
Raise with 4+ card support: 2♥
No support: 2♠ (showing a long spade suit)

Raise with 4+ card support: 3♥
No support: 3♦ (showing a long diamond suit)

Raise with 4+ card support: 3♥
No support: 3♠ (showing a long spade suit)

Balanced hand: choose game or invite (3NT / 4♥)

Preemptive: bid your best contract



KEY TAKEAWAY: The opener's rebid describes strength and distribution.
Know the rules, watch the Safety Level, and communicate clearly!